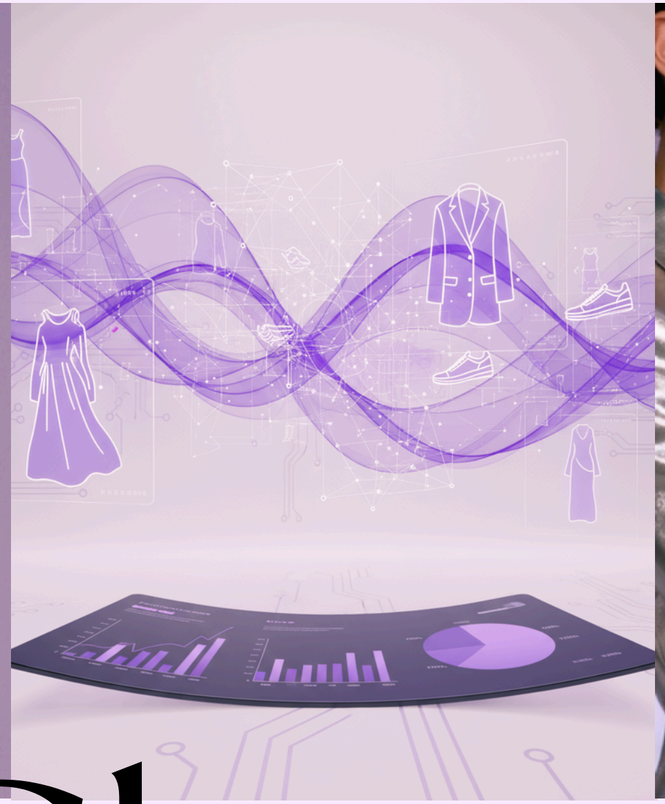
CREATE. SHOP. INFLUENCE



ShopSight

TEAM SHOPFLUENCE: KAREENA SHAH, VEDANT LAKAHANI, SHWETA MITTAL, MICHEL LULO

By submitting this assignment, the members of our team affirm that we all participated in the creation of this document.

User Persona #1 - Trendy Taylor (Genz student)

WHO ?

AGE

18-23

EDUCATION

Undergraduate student

LIVING SITUATION

Shared apartments or campus housing

LOCATION

Urban college town (Durham)

JOB TITLE/SALARY

Part-time, on-campus job

COMMUNICATION PREFERENCES

Prefers casual, quick chats through social media



HOW ?

MARKETING MESSAGING
How should you describe your solution to persona

Shape the trends you love. Discover, create, and inspire together

ELEVATOR PITCH
Sell your persona on your solution!

ShopSight helps you spot what's next, share your ideas, and make brands actually listen while keeping shopping fun and authentic

WHAT ?

GOALS
Primary/Secondary

- Discover unique looks early and express personal identity
- Influence friends' style choices with confident picks
- Buy from brands that feel transparent and thoughtful

CHALLENGES
Primary/Secondary

- Choice overload across many apps; inspiration is scattered
- Low trust in vague sustainability claims
- Feels brands drop products that don't reflect what genz actually want

WHAT CAN WE DO

- Create real-time design challenges and voting so ideas reach brand.
- Strengthen social loops for quick feedback and confidence.
- Show proof for sustainability (materials, factories, impact)

WHY ?

REAL QUOTES
About goals, challenges etc.

- "Pinterest is the dream board. TikTok is reality. I trust normal people way more than brands."
- "Every brand says 'sustainable' now. It's so fake. If an app actually showed receipts, I'd use it."
- "When my friends try something new, we all end up with it a week later."

COMMON OBJECTIONS
Why wouldn't they use your service

- May see it as "just another shopping app" rather than a place to be heard
- Will not trust the platform if sustainability proof is unclear
- Will disengage if participation does not lead to visible brand response
- Will avoid it if the experience feels cluttered or slow

User Persona #2 - Practical Parker (Young working professional)

WHO ?

AGE

25-30

EDUCATION

Masters degree

LIVING SITUATION

Lives independently

LOCATION

New York City

JOB TITLE/SALARY

Product Manager, ~ $120K

COMMUNICATION PREFERENCES

Prefers clear, concise email communication



HOW ?

MARKETING MESSAGING
How should you describe your solution to persona

- Shape what brands create without adding more to your plate.
- Quick, credible ways to influence the future of fashion, built for real people with real lives.

ELEVATOR PITCH
Sell your persona on your solution!

ShopSight fits into your packed routine by giving you quick, credible ways to shape fashion before it's made, so brands finally create pieces that match your standards, lifestyle, and values.

WHAT ?

GOALS
Primary/Secondary

- Build a versatile wardrobe for work and daily life.
- Make informed purchases that balance quality, price, and value.
- Avoid trend chasing but still stay "in the loop" socially

CHALLENGES
Primary/Secondary

- Overwhelmed by influencer-heavy fashion products that don't reflect her reality
- Limited time and mental energy to navigate cluttered e-commerce experiences after work

WHAT CAN WE DO

- Provide easy ways to participate (1-click voting, curated challenges)
- Show the impact of user input through real brand stories
- Personalize content to avoid overwhelming them with noise

WHY ?

REAL QUOTES
About goals, challenges etc.

- "I returned it, but it's not like anyone at H&M ever cares why. That's the part that bugs me, they don't even ask."
- "I scroll Revolve and it feels like everything's for influencers at Coachella. None of it works for someone catching the subway to Midtown."
- "Sometimes I want to be like, stop pretending, we see through this."

COMMON OBJECTIONS
Why wouldn't they use your service

- Unsure how the platform would fit into a busy daily routine
- Skeptical that community feedback would actually influence brands
- Concerned it may feel too influencer-focused and not relevant to her lifestyle
- Worries initial interest may fade quickly without clear, ongoing value

How Customer Personas Inform Ideation & Future Research

IMPACT ON IDEATION

- Sharpens feature prioritization
  - Persona insights reveal distinct user motivations like creative expression vs. pragmatic efficiency and helping us decide which existing web features (e.g., design challenges vs. FuturePulse reports) should anchor the mobile experience first.
- Clarifies sustainability storytelling angles
  - Understanding user skepticism and values guides how we ideate sustainability touchpoints, e.g., making impact dashboards transparent for credibility or embedding eco-badges and progress visuals for emotional resonance.
- Informs the balance between discovery and participation features
  - Different engagement patterns push us to ideate the right mix between social, challenge-driven features and quick, insight-driven tools, avoiding feature overload in the first app version.
- Helps define MVP boundaries
  - Personas surface which features feel essential vs. nice-to-have for early adoption, guiding us to draw a clearer line between browser and app experiences.
- Shapes communication and incentives
  - Insights into trust gaps, time constraints, and desire for recognition help ideation around feedback loops, reward structures, and how sustainability benefits are framed to drive engagement.



FURTHER NEEDED RESEARCH

- Targeted Follow-Up Interviews
  - Conduct additional interviews with stakeholders to explore their fashion discovery habits, attitudes toward sustainability, and expectations from mobile experiences. This will help refine motivations, pain points, and trust drivers in our personas.
- Quick Pulse Surveys
  - Distribute short surveys to a wider sample to validate emerging patterns (e.g., interest in sustainability features) and ensure our personas reflect broader segment behaviors, not just individual interviews.
- Contextual Inquiry / Informal Observation
  - Observe peers or volunteers as they browse fashion platforms to understand how they switch between inspiration, decision-making, and purchasing, revealing hidden behaviors and friction points to enrich persona journeys.
- Engagement & Motivation Mapping
  - Run short ranking activities with a few users to understand what types of app features (e.g., creative challenges vs. quick polls) actually motivate them to participate.
- Sustainability Perception Check
  - Explore how users currently interpret sustainability messaging (e.g., badges, impact statements) through A/B content reviews, to refine how we capture values and trust factors in personas.